LIFE SKILLS WORKSHOPS · GUIDE QUICK REFERENCE

Workshop Pitching

ALPHA SCHOOL
ALPHACORE

Pitch | Facilitate | Coach | AlphaTest

Four components of every workshop — not a strict order. You design the AlphaTest as you pitch, and coaching runs throughout.

What is Workshop Pitching?

Pitching is where a workshop gets **designed and approved — before a single student starts.** In the Co-Pilot you lock the life skill and sub-skill, session structure, real-world plan, and the Skill Roadmap that ends in your AlphaTest statement. Once approved, that pitch **is** the workshop you run.

Before You Design: Two Inputs

1 · Know the skill

The **S1–S5 Roadmap** names the life skill for your session. Before designing anything, go into the **Knowledge Tree** and get fluent in what that skill means at Alpha and looks like in practice. "Learn to Learn" on the roadmap is a starting point, not a definition — it's very hard to design around a skill you haven't unpacked.

Roadmap ▸ Life skill ▸ Knowledge Tree ▸ **ONE sub-skill**

2 · Know your kids

One of the best moves you can make: **have students vote** on what they want next session. Campuses and levels differ, and real student interest is the easiest way to make the cheese irresistible.

Build It in 3 Moves

1 Lock the Fundamentals
One life skill, **ONE** sub-skill, up to 3 days/week, 6–8 weeks.

2 Build the Guide's Guide
Concrete summary + Real-World plan: **IRL · Data Tracking · Mastery Model · Motivational Model**

3 Lock the Skill Roadmap

Baseline ▸ Checkpoint 1 ▸ Checkpoint 2 ▸ **AlphaTest**

The BANGER Bar

- **B** **Buzzworthy** — kids talk about it
- **A** **Agency** — students make real choices
- **N** **Normed & Nationally Noteworthy** — holds up outside Alpha
- **G** **Grounded in Life Skill** — the skill is the point
- **E** **Excellence** — the output is genuinely good
- **R** **Real-World** — real stakes and audience

Not every workshop has to be a BANGER. Going for it? Every bar must read Met at submission. Either way, your AlphaTest clears all 7 conditions. →

Your AlphaTest Statement Must Be...

- **Binary** — Passed or Not Yet, no judgment call
- **Locked** in writing before launch
- **About the life skill**, not just the task
- **Cheese + broccoli** — kids say it back excited
- **Clear on format** — live, or an approved showcase
- **Right for the grade band**
- **Word-for-word** with the AlphaTest tab

Cheese = the hook. **Broccoli** = the skill. The medium carries the cheese: *"I can bike 5 miles nonstop."*

Before You Submit

- **Baseline measures the skill** they walk in with, not the task.
- **Checkpoint 1 ≠ Checkpoint 2 ≠ AlphaTest** — three distinct milestones.
- **Summary: 3–5 concrete sentences.** No marketing language.
- **Pick a medium you can run** — venue, gear, partner, budget.
- **Kid test:** students can name their AlphaTest by week 2.
- **Expect a revision cycle** — few pitches clear on the first pass.

Need to change a committed pitch?

You can now **edit a committed pitch** — for serious logistical or operational changes, not to soften a standard mid-workshop.

Have a question? Struggling to bring your vision to life?
Send a Slack to **#alphacore-support**

RESOURCES — Co-Pilot | Knowledge Tree | BANGER GPT | BANGER Examples | S1–S5 Roadmap

LIFE SKILLS WORKSHOPS · GUIDE QUICK REFERENCE

Workshop Facilitation

ALPHA SCHOOL
ALPHACORE

Pitch | **Facilitate** | Coach | AlphaTest

Four components of every workshop — not a strict order. You design the AlphaTest as you pitch, and coaching runs throughout.

What is Workshop Facilitation?

Facilitation is **running the approved workshop and making it better every class.** Track each student and the whole group toward the AlphaTest, watch what's landing, take real-time feedback from kids, and iterate. The goalposts don't move — almost everything else can.

1 **Week 1 · Baseline** — Where each student starts

2 **Checkpoint 1** — Real milestone — on track?

3 **Checkpoint 2** — AlphaTest readiness

★ **AlphaTest** — Passed / Not Yet

~12–14 CLASSES · EVERY STUDENT TRACKED · EVERY CLASS EARNS ITS PLACE

Plan Every Class Like It Counts

A workshop is **12–14 classes** that have to land every student AlphaTest-ready. Map that arc backwards from the standard before week 1, then sharpen it as you go.

- **Every class carries cheese and broccoli.** All broccoli and kids check out; all cheese and nothing gets built.
- **No filler days.** Every class visibly moves students closer.
- **Kids can name their AlphaTest** and the life skill they're building — any week, not just at the end.
- **Reps under real conditions,** so the AlphaTest isn't the first time it counts.
- **Ask them weekly:** what was fun, what was hard, what would make this better?

What's Owed at Each Stage

Week 1 Baseline	Status + evidence for **every** student — where they actually start
Check point 1	Status + evidence · a **coaching plan** for anyone behind
Check point 2	Status + evidence · coaching plan · an honest **readiness call**
Alpha Test	**Passed / Not Yet** + evidence, recorded that day. See the **AlphaTest WUD** for retesting parameters.

Evidence means evidence: a real score, checklist, percentage or recording link specific to that student — not one line copied down the roster.

What to Keep, What to Adjust

Keep fixed

- The AlphaTest standard
- Life skill & sub-skill
- Checkpoint thresholds
- The pitched cadence

Try adjusting

- Activities and format
- Contests and incentives
- Framing, hype, reframes
- Grouping, guests, venue

Example. Kids already biking 5 miles by week 3? Run a **most-miles-in-training leaderboard** rather than moving the standard. Real logistical or operational changes *can* shift a checkpoint or AlphaTest — that's the ladder below, not a solo call.

Make the Progress Visible

Turn each week into a stage kids can see and finish.

- **Badges per stage.** Finish the week, earn the badge; collect them all before the AlphaTest.
- **Put it on the wall.** A physical tracker beats a spreadsheet nobody sees — digital too, if it fits.
- **Checkpoints unlock something.** Rollerskating unlocked custom stickers, helmets and bags.
- A big goal **7 weeks away** can be very abstract for a kid. Breaking it into smaller, shorter-term stages helps their motivation and development.

↑ When Real Kids Meet the Plan

Baselines and checkpoints were written **before you met these students.** A low baseline isn't a failure — it's data on where they start. No consequence for the student, no bearing on passing.

1 Adjust what you control — activities, coaching, incentives, framing. **2** Bring it to your Lead or Head Guide. **3** Request AlphaCore support: **#alphacore-support**. **4** Together decide if a checkpoint truly needs adjusting.

RESOURCES Workshop Skill Tracker · Guide's Guide · Knowledge Tree · S1–S5 Roadmap

LIFE SKILLS WORKSHOPS · GUIDE QUICK REFERENCE

Workshop Coaching

ALPHA SCHOOL
ALPHACORE

Pitch | Facilitate | **Coach** | AlphaTest

Four components of every workshop — not a strict order. You design the AlphaTest as you pitch, and coaching runs throughout.

What is Workshop Coaching?

Coaching is the **motivational and emotional support that grows the life skill itself** — not the task, not the score. It runs from day one to the week after the AlphaTest: naming the skill, reading where each kid is, giving one clear next move at a time, and using what you know about them to keep them in it.

Coaching at Every Stage

Week 1 Baseline	**Name the skill and the destination.** "Here's where you are, here's your AlphaTest." A low baseline is a starting point, never a verdict.
Between classes	**Catch it early.** Short, specific, in the moment — name the skill when you see it, and once a week give each kid one thing to work on.
Check point 1	**Make progress visible.** Show them how far they've moved from Baseline; for anyone behind, one move and a plan they helped shape.
Check point 2	**Honest readiness + pressure prep.** Last real chance to name what's missing while there's still time to fix it.
After AlphaTest	**Reflect, then wise feedback within 24 hours** — pass or Not Yet — and cue the skill again during the week.

Match the Support to the Gap

Doesn't know what good looks like	**Modeling**
Can do it with help, not alone	**Coaching + fading**
Progress has stalled	**Deep practice**
Falls apart under pressure	**Pressure ladder**
Only performs when told to	**Mixed practice**
Doesn't transfer the skill	**Pattern-ID**

Diagnose before you intervene — a kid who doesn't know what good looks like needs modeling, not more pressure.

Coach the Whole Kid

- **Use confidence anchors.** "You did the showcase last session — same nerve." Past wins are the fastest way back into belief.
- **Borrow from the rest of their day.** Check chart time, Limitless meetings, recess, sports, other workshops — the skill shows up there too, and naming it there makes it real.
- **Use what you know about them** — who they work well with, what they're proud of, what they avoid.
- **Talk to the guides who have them elsewhere** — someone may already have the move that works.
- **Cleared the bar early? Keep them climbing** — a stretch target, a class competition, a peer-mentor role.
- **Protect the identity, not just the output:** "you're becoming someone who finishes hard things," not "you did the task."

Wise Feedback (Use It All Session)

"You showed real **[life skill]** when you ____. I know you can grow this skill even further — the bar is high because you're capable. Next time, focus on ____."

Exactly **ONE** next move — small, behavioral, testable this week. Name the **skill**, never the task or the score.

STUDENT REFLECTION — AFTER THE ALPHATEST, OR ANY CHECKPOINT

The life skill I'm working on is ____. One moment I showed it was ____. It got hard when ____. One move to strengthen it is ____.

(journal · 1:1 · vlog — vague answer? "What moment felt hardest?")

A Not Yet is Version 1

Reframe it as Version 1 building toward Version 2 — never pass/fail language. **Diagnose:** execution miss (had the skill, didn't use it under pressure) or skill gap (doesn't have the move yet)? **Isolate one component** and give it one or two focused reps — not a full AlphaTest redo. **Re-demonstrate** early in the next session and affirm it as mastery of the skill.

Log it all in the student's **Post-AlphaTest Coaching Feedback** field. Stuck on a reframe or a diagnosis? Slack **#alphacore-support**.

RESOURCES Workshop Skill Tracker · Knowledge Tree · Guide's Guide · S1–S5 Roadmap

LIFE SKILLS WORKSHOPS · GUIDE QUICK REFERENCE

The AlphaTest

ALPHA SCHOOL
ALPHACORE

Pitch | Facilitate | Coach | **AlphaTest**

Four components of every workshop — not a strict order. You design the AlphaTest as you pitch, and coaching runs throughout.

What is the AlphaTest Event?

The AlphaTest is where the life skill gets **performed in public against the locked standard** — the moment a parent watches their kid do something genuinely impressive. The statement was written at pitch time; this is the event that tests it. **Real bar, real audience, real skill** — it has to be all three.

Cheese
The hook, the competition, the reason they signed up.

LOOKS LIKE THE CHEESE MEASURES THE BROCCOLI

Broccoli
The rigor underneath. All cheese is a party; all broccoli is an exam.

Strive for Live, Showcase When Needed

Can the standard be performed live, on the day?

YES → LIVE
Students perform in front of families and classmates. Nerves are part of the test.

NO → SHOWCASE
Demo day, bazaar, pitch panel, sales competition — students **defend real results live**.

Decide the format at pitch time. A showcase picked late for convenience is what to avoid. The bar never moves — only how it gets witnessed.

METRIC | EVENT | ACCOLADE | EXPERT MATCH | EXPERT APPRAISAL

Before the Day

- **Rehearse under AlphaTest conditions.** Checkpoint 2 is the dress rehearsal — same format, same limits, an audience watching.
- **Borrow an audience early** — another class, a few parents, guides from another level. The event shouldn't be their first time in front of strangers.
- **Give every student a plan for the moment** — an opening line, a pre-start routine, and a reset for when something goes wrong.
- **Normalize the nerves.** Practice performing *while* nervous instead of trying to remove it.
- **Walk the run of show** — who goes when, where they stand. A confident student first sets the tone.

On the Day

1. **Score against the locked standard as written,** with the audience right there. Applause is not evidence.
2. **Parents never decide the outcome.** They can be part of the event, never part of the passing criteria.
3. **Record Passed or Not Yet + evidence that day,** however busy the room is.
4. **Deliver a Not Yet honestly** — in private where you can, never softened into a pass in front of a family.
5. **Every student receives coaching** — pass or not. A Not Yet comes with a re-test opportunity, named before they leave.

Not Yet? Change the Staging, Not the Standard

ALPHATEST	RE-TEST
Bike 5 miles nonstop at a live race	5 miles unbroken on a stationary bike at school

- **Replicable** (Metric, Accolade): just re-run the full standard under the same rubric.
- **Non-replicable** (a one-time live or community event): an authorized re-test that keeps the capability and difficulty — change venue, audience, equipment, date.
- **Authorized by someone other than you** — your Lead Guide — with the reasoning recorded. **A retest pass is a pass;** the attempt number carries the history.

Plan It With the Team

Lead / Head Guide + your team: decide early which workshops are showcased this session, in what form, and how they share a day or space.

Events team: communicate showcase needs — venue, setup, equipment, timing, invitations — well ahead.

Media: videographer and photographer requests go through **Gaby Guajardo**. Tricky re-test call? Slack **#alphacore-support**.

RESOURCES AlphaTest Tab | Workshop Skill Tracker | Past AlphaTests | Knowledge Tree